



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Pangaea Schoolhouse

School Website: <https://pangaeaschoolhouse.com/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Pangaea Schoolhouse appears to be a modern, faith-integrated microschool in Fountain Hills, AZ that explicitly aligns with classical education in its stated framework and practices. The public materials consistently reference the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), the aim to form mind and character, and a pedagogy that blends Socratic dialogue with integrated, project-oriented learning. The school foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, emphasizes virtue and wisdom as primary goals, and positions parents as partners in formation. Several elements—classical foundations, Socratic discussion, and a strong emphasis on virtue and faith—are clearly present. However, explicit mentions of Great Books/Great Conversation and some traditional memory-based practices (e.g., recitation, chanting, scholé-day memory work) are not as prominently documented in the accessible materials, which places some aspects of the classic program as aspirational rather than fully explicit on the site.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Key insights: - The school clearly centers truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and faith within its mission and daily practice (e.g., daily prayer, Christ-centered community, pursuit of wisdom and virtue) which aligns strongly with the classical end of formation. This is well-supported in the materials. - The Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) is explicitly named and integrated with modern, inquiry-based learning, indicating a robust classical scaffolding in curriculum and pedagogy. - The public materials emphasize partnership with parents and an engaged community, with multiple pathways (in-person, online, homeschool alliance), which supports a classical ideal of a virtuous community formed in partnership with families.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit references to truth, goodness, and beauty as central ideals; integrated faith framing; Christ-centered community; daily prayer. Examples include passages describing truth, goodness, and beauty guiding learning and a faith-centered approach (e.g., “truth, goodness, and beauty,” “Faith at the Center,” and daily prayer).
 - The framework links learning with virtue and moral formation, including “formation of mind and character” and a Christian worldview anchored in divine wisdom (Proverbs 2:6 language appears in program materials).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, faith, theology (implicitly), prayer, Christ-centered, sacred, wisdom, wisdom-formation.
 - Negative keywords: none prominent in the accessible materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral framing detected in the public text).

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- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently tie education to transcendent moral realities, virtue formation, and religious framing, aligning with Transcendental moral realism and a theology-grounded, liturgical sensibility. The presence of explicit faith-integrated language and prayer supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Clear statements about forming wisdom and virtue rather than merely preparing for work: “education should form both the mind and the character,” and “cultivate wisdom, virtue, and curiosity.” The overarching aim is formation and human flourishing, not solely workforce preparation.
 - Public articulations of uniting faith, classical learning, and modern discovery point to a telos oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty rather than a narrow job-readiness frame.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, true/good/beautiful, scholé, contemplative aim (indirectly via formation and character).
 - Negative keywords: none evident (no emphasis on workforce-centric language in the public materials).
- Why this rating
 - The school frames education as formation and human excellence anchored in virtue and wisdom, consistent with the classical ideal of paideia rather than exclusively job preparation. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit mention of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as a core framework of study. This anchors classical curriculum components.
 - Descriptions of integrated study across literature, math, scripture, science, and art, with a focus on classical foundations and inquiry-based learning.
 - The public materials emphasize classical foundations and a unified approach; however, explicit public mention of Great Books and the Great Conversation is not clearly documented in the accessible pages.
 - Socratic dialogue is explicitly referenced as part of upper-level pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), liberal arts, great conversation (mentioned in canonical classical framework though not clearly in site text), Socratic discussions, integrated curriculum, memory-focused elements (implied in classical pedagogy), wonder.
 - Negative keywords: The site does not prominently reference project-based learning as the dominant mode; however, project-based inquiry is described as part of the modern integration (not a negative signal, but an indicator of blended pedagogy rather than purely classic). The lexicon's strict negative signals (e.g., “experiential learning focus” or “constructivist-only”) are not clearly evidenced as dominant.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly embodies core classical components, especially the Trivium and Socratic dialogue; but the explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation is not clearly documented in the public pages provided. Because the curriculum is strongly classical in key elements but not fully explicit on all classical-curriculum markers, it lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- Socratic discussions and seminars are explicitly described as part of upper-level pedagogy, with emphasis on logic and argumentation. This aligns with classical pedagogy in the upper grades.
 - There is explicit emphasis on integrated learning, inquiry-based projects, and cross-disciplinary exploration, which aligns with modern application but can diverge from a strict “memory/recitation/retentive” memory-first pedagogy in classic models. The materials also emphasize that lower levels may involve practices like singing and ritualized routines, though direct evidence of singing/chanting in lower grades is not clearly documented in the pages provided.
 - The school emphasizes “not rushed, but rooted” learning and contemplative moments, which correspond to scholé and contemplative learning advocated in classical frameworks.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussions, seminars, debates, rhetoric, memory work (implied by classical pedagogy), contemplative/restful learning (scholé language is not explicit, but the ethos aligns with contemplative pacing).
 - Negative keywords: Some purely project-based/experiential-only pedagogy signals would be a risk if dominant; however the site presents a blended approach that includes Socratic, traditional discussion alongside inquiry-based projects, reducing the risk of a purely constructivist approach.
 - Why this rating
 - The presence of Socratic dialogue and rhetoric-based training signals a strong classical pedagogy, but the blend with modern inquiry and project-based learning suggests not fully adherent to the stricter old-school classical pedagogy. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials describe teachers as “guides who know students personally,” mentoring, and forming the learning experience; the living-curriculum framing indicates teachers are central to the educational formation.
 - References to small classes, individualized mentoring, and multi-grade environments reflect a teacher-centered, character-forming model where faculty act as mentors and living curriculum.
 - The school emphasizes a family-like culture where teachers are model practitioners and partners in formation; the community design supports a “portrait of teacher” and “living curriculum” concept.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, personalized mentoring, small-class pedagogy, teachers who know students personally.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials (no signaling language that contradicts classical teacher-mentorship ideals).
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently position faculty as central exemplars and living curriculum, with a strong mentorship culture, supporting CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit partnership with parents and co-teaching orientation; parent participation is framed as essential to the learning journey.
 - The materials describe open campus possibilities and ongoing parent engagement in formation, book studies, gatherings, and related activities that align with classical-community expectations.
 - The school emphasizes that families participate in the learning process and that the school and families form a community of virtue and inquiry, including accessible enrollment coordination and parent involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups/book clubs (as implied by ongoing parent formation activities), open campus, family in-

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- involvement.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The school presents a robust model of parent-community partnership, consistent with classical expectations for family engagement and formation of learners within a shared community. This supports CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly reference and document Great Books participation and the Great Conversation in curricular materials (or on the Programs/Academics pages). Provide a public statement or page outlining reading lists and a stated commitment to Great Books as part of the liberal arts core. Also consider clarifying how history is threaded through the curriculum (as a continuous through-line rather than isolated “subjects”) to align with classical history study. This would strengthen the category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL. See the Six Elements framework for Great Books/Great Conversation cues and the Trivium emphasis.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Reinforce and publicly document traditional memory-work and recitation elements (e.g., prose, poetry, dictation, progymnasmata-style practice) alongside Socratic seminars and project-based work. Making memory-work and recitation part of a formal pedagogy section would push this category toward CLASSICAL. The presence of Socratic dialogue is strong; adding explicit memory-oriented pedagogy would align more fully with the classical model described in the Six Elements lexicon.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Consider codifying and publicizing a formal “portrait of a teacher” and a clearer articulation of “living curriculum” in staff profiles and mission statements. While the current materials imply these aspects, a formal, public articulation would strengthen the category’s CLASSICAL alignment.
- For Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) and Element 1 (Religious Foundations) no major needle-moving changes are required, given the strong presence of formation, virtue, and faith integrated into daily practice and mission.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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